

County Administration Workshop: August 4, 2026

1:30 p.m. - Board of Commissioners Conference Room

Attending: Commissioners Colene M. Martin, Vice-Chair; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman, Recorder. Excused: Commissioner Ron A. Smith, Chair.

Vice-Chair Colene Martin called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

1. Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

Commissioners Richardson and Martin each declared no potential conflicts of interest regarding the matters before the Board.

2. Department Business

a. Treasurer

1. Yearly Readoption of Investment Policy

Dustin Calvo, County Treasurer, presented the annual readoption of the Josephine County Investment Policy. Mr. Calvo explained that portions of the policy contain outdated statutory citations and language and require a comprehensive revision. He recommended temporary readoption so the County would retain the policy safeguards governing investment diversification, qualified financial institutions, credit quality, and investment authority while the revised policy is prepared. Mr. Calvo stated that, without readoption, the Board would need to issue a written order authorizing the Treasurer to continue investing County funds, and the County would otherwise rely primarily upon minimum statutory requirements. Major revisions will require review by the Oregon Short Term Fund Board before the updated policy can return to the Board for final adoption.

Commissioner Richardson moved to readopt the Josephine County Investment Policy as presented solely to preserve the County's authority under ORS 294.135 to hold investments beyond 18 months and to direct the Treasurer to prepare and present a revised policy incorporating the corrections identified in the staff review, including updated statutory citations, FINRA-compliant broker qualifications, credit-rating floors, repurchase-agreement term limits, and an updated authorized-institution list for Oregon Short Term Fund Board review and final adoption at a future meeting. Commissioner Martin seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Absent. Motion carried 2-0.

b. Community Justice

1. Josephine County Provider Contract with Continuum Behavioral Health and Recovery Services (formerly OnTrack)

Scott Hyde, Community Justice Director, presented a provider contract with Continuum Behavioral Health and Recovery Services, formerly known as OnTrack, for outpatient substance-use-disorder treatment. The contract is funded through the Oregon Health Authority Intergovernmental Agreement previously approved by the Board, which provides approximately \$8.31 million for mental-health and substance-use-disorder treatment services in Josephine County.

The contract begins January 1, 2026, and continues through June 30, 2027, unless the underlying agreement is amended, extended, or terminated. The maximum amount payable under the contract is \$125,000. Mr. Hyde stated that Continuum joins ADAPT and Choices Counseling Center as the three providers receiving awards from this portion of the State funding. Mr. Hyde confirmed that Community Justice will collect program data and can provide the Board with information regarding the services delivered and the use of the awarded funds.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve the Josephine County Provider Contract with Continuum Behavioral Health and Recovery Services in an amount not to exceed \$125,000 and authorize the required Board signatures. Commissioner Martin seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Absent. Motion carried 2-0.

c. Sheriff/Emergency Management**1. 2026-2027 Emergency Management Performance Grant (EMPG) - Designation of Nathan Sanders and Matthew Eide as Authorized Agents**

Vice-Chair Martin and Finance Director Matt Eide explained that Emergency Management must annually designate authorized agents for the Emergency Management Performance Grant. The proposed designation would replace the Sheriff, who had served during the interim Emergency Management period, with Emergency Management Director Nathan Sanders and Finance Director Matthew Eide. Mr. Sanders would prepare and submit program documentation, and Finance would review and certify the required financial information.

Commissioner Richardson moved to designate Nathan Sanders and Matthew Eide as authorized agents for the 2026-2027 Emergency Management Performance Grant. Commissioner Martin seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Absent. Motion carried 2-0.

d. Information Technology**1. Strategic Communications Planning**

Thomas Gray, Public Relations Officer, presented a draft Josephine County Strategic Communications Plan and accompanying presentation. Mr. Gray explained that the plan is intended to establish a Countywide framework that individual departments can use when developing more detailed communications plans. The document is designed to remain adaptable and to be revised as the County receives feedback and evaluates the effectiveness of its communications.

The proposed communications goal focuses on informing and protecting Josephine County through transparency, access to County services, community-building opportunities, and protection of the County government's reputation. The initial measurable objectives include increasing annual follower counts by 15 percent for County Facebook and Instagram accounts with fewer than 5,000 followers; bringing County websites and mobile applications into compliance with federal accessibility standards by April 26, 2027; and establishing baseline website-traffic and social-media-engagement measurements.

Mr. Gray reviewed proposed core messages emphasizing public service, safety, functionality, integrity, accurate and timely information, efficient use of alternative funding, and the value of community participation in local government. He also reviewed the plan's audience analysis, strategies, communication tactics, measurement methods, and appendices for future tactics, department-specific communications goals, the social-media administrative policy, and the County branding guide. Mr. Gray requested constructive feedback from the Board and County leadership. He planned to present the draft at the managers meeting, incorporate two rounds of review, and return a near-final or final plan to the Board for formal adoption. Commissioners expressed appreciation for the work and encouraged all department directors and managers to participate in the review process. No formal action was taken.

e. Human Resources**1. Position Requisition****a) Sheriff's Department - Advanced Deputy Patrol - Rehire**

Natalie Eckhardt-Doupe, Interim Human Resources Director, presented a position requisition to rehire a former Josephine County deputy at the advanced-deputy classification. The candidate previously worked for Josephine County for approximately six years before accepting employment with Jackson County. Ms. Eckhardt-Doupe stated that this would be the first advanced deputy hired by the County since before 2021 and that the candidate could return with substantial experience without requiring basic academy training.

The Board expressed support for welcoming the deputy back to Josephine County and noted that the employee's prior experience would reduce training time and expense. Human Resources will complete the remaining hiring requirements and issue a final offer when the process is complete. No separate formal motion was made.

3. Board Business**a. Communications**

Commissioner Martin reported that she had continued meeting with stakeholders regarding grant opportunities and the development of a replacement public-safety communications system. She stated that the project remained a County priority but would likely require an extended planning, funding, engineering, and implementation process.

Commissioner Richardson requested that fire districts and other emergency-response partners remain included in the preliminary, systemwide review, even though local fire agencies use different tower systems. The Board discussed

identifying potential shared sites, equipment compatibility, and opportunities for collaboration before narrowing the project scope based on cost.

Commissioner Martin reported that State and federal communications personnel were reviewing tower locations and system users. She stated that the standing communications item could be removed from the workshop agenda until additional technical and funding information was available. No formal action was taken.

b. Review of County Fuel Purchasing and P-Card Guidance

Public Works Director Rob Brandes and Finance Director Matt Eide reviewed County fuel-purchasing practices. They explained that the most economical option is the bulk-fuel facility at Public Works, followed by use of the County-issued Pacific Pride fuel card. Purchases at other stations are permitted when operational needs, travel, location, or access make the preferred options impractical.

The County budgets for approximately 150,000 gallons of fuel annually. The Sheriff's Office uses nearly half of that amount, and Transit accounts for approximately 30 percent. Staff noted that the price difference between the Public Works bulk rate and higher-priced retail stations can approach one dollar per gallon, making advance planning and use of the preferred fuel sources financially significant.

County-issued purchasing cards are not the preferred method for routine fuel purchases. Finance reviews purchasing-card transactions and follows up when a card is used for fuel instead of the County fuel system or Pacific Pride card. The Board did not request a formal report but supported periodic reminders to employees regarding the available fuel options and the importance of cost-conscious planning. No formal action was taken.

4. Other

None.

5. Additional Subject Matters from Commissioners/Announcements

The Board congratulated Chris Richardson for receiving a champion ribbon for a blueberry entry at the Josephine County Fair.

Commissioners thanked Recreation Director Tamra Martin, Fairgrounds staff, 4-H participants, volunteers, and community members for a successful Fair and livestock auction. They noted the favorable weather, strong participation, and the work required to coordinate the event.

The Board also reminded residents to know their evacuation zones and remain prepared during fire season.

The meeting adjourned at 2:15 p.m.